

Press Release

Prague, 19 November 2025

Prague hosts one of Europe's largest conferences on the internationalisation of higher education. CEEDUCON 2025 kicks off

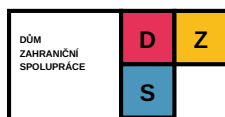
Today in Prague, the seventh edition of the international conference **CEEDUCON 2025** begins, the largest Central European forum focused on the internationalisation of higher education. The two-day event, organised by the **Czech National Agency for International Education and Research (DZS)** in cooperation with national agencies for international education from Austria, Germany, Poland, Slovakia and Hungary, is one of the most important events in the field of international cooperation among higher education institutions in Europe. At Prague's O2 universum on 19 and 20 November, it will bring together **more than 900 participants from universities in the Czech Republic and abroad, prestigious international think tanks, public administration, the European Commission and other international institutions**. More than **50 panels, lectures and workshops** led by over **130 speakers** from around the world are on the programme.

The conference is opened by **Michal Uhl**, Director of DZS, together with **Jaroslav Miller**, Chair of the National Accreditation Bureau for Tertiary Education (NAÚ). The keynote speaker this year is **Stefan Zotti**, Deputy Head of the Higher Education Unit at the European Commission's Directorate-General for Education, Youth, Sport and Culture (DG EAC). Zotti is one of Europe's leading experts on higher education policy; he has served as an adviser to the Austrian Minister for Science and Research, a member of Commissioner Johannes Hahn's cabinet, and Director of the Austrian agency OeAD.

"International cooperation is now one of the keys to the quality and resilience of European education. CEEDUCON also gives space to the most pressing current issues - including the debate on the future budget of the Erasmus+ programme. This is absolutely essential if Europe is to remain an open and interconnected space where ideas, talent and innovation can be exchanged. Without a substantial increase in funding, it will be impossible not only to strengthen the direction we have set, but even to maintain it. This is what makes CEEDUCON unique: it brings together experts, academics and policymakers who can work together to find solutions to these questions," said Michal Uhl, Director of DZS.

Each year, an expert jury selects **four thematic tracks** that best reflect current academic and geopolitical developments. These are **Smart & Sustainable International Cooperation**, **Internationalisation for All**, **Global & Regional Partnerships**, and **systematic work with alumni focusing on connecting universities with the labour market and private sector** (Alumni - Employability - Future Skills).

Discussions will focus, among other topics, on how internationalisation can help institutions adapt to the rapid development of AI and digital technologies, how to support student exchanges and professional traineeships at a time of geopolitical uncertainty, and how to make international experiences accessible to broader groups of students and academic staff.



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In the Czech demographic, economic and geopolitical context, particular attention will be paid to seminars presenting the latest findings on the skills **employers expect from graduates in STEM fields**, a comparison of Czech and Estonian approaches to **working with international students and graduates**, and data from the Netherlands and Germany illustrating the **motivations of international graduates to stay in or leave** the country where they studied.

The conference, which has steadily grown over six years under the name CZEDUCON, will take on a new name this year, better reflecting its **broader European scope and international significance** (CEEDUCON - Central European Education Conference).

For more information, please contact:

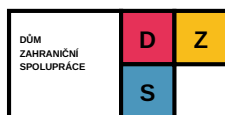
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Czech National Agency for International Education and Research

The Czech National Agency for International Education and Research (DZS) is a contributory organisation of the Ministry of Education, Youth and Sports. Its core activities include administering programmes focused on international education and promoting Czech education abroad. More information about DZS activities is available at dzs.cz.



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